

1. Tell me about a time you improved performance in your project.

STAR Answer

S: Our API was slow and taking almost 2 seconds.

T: I had to reduce the response time.

A: I checked logs, found heavy DB calls, added caching and optimized queries.

R: API came down to 400–500 ms and the team appreciated the fix.

2. Describe a situation where you fixed a production issue quickly.

STAR Answer

S: A customer reported that login was failing in production.

T: I had to find the issue fast.

A: Checked logs, identified a null pointer, patched the code, rolled out hotfix.

R: Production was stable again within 30 minutes.

3. Tell me about a time you handled multiple tasks or deadlines.

STAR Answer

S: I had 2 features and a bug at the same time.

T: I needed to finish all before sprint end.

A: I prioritized based on impact, finished highest priority work first, then completed other tasks.

R: All items were completed within sprint and with proper testing.

4. Describe a conflict in your team and how you solved it.

STAR Answer

S: Two teammates disagreed on API design.

T: It was delaying the story.

A: I proposed a quick design meeting, gathered pros/cons, and suggested a simpler common approach.

R: Team agreed and we finished the API on time.

5. Tell me about a time you redesigned something for better structure.

STAR Answer

S: Our service had repeated code for validation.

T: I needed to clean it.

A: I created a reusable validator class and replaced duplicate logic.

R: Code became cleaner and easier to maintain.

6. Describe a time when you mentored a junior developer.

STAR Answer

S: A junior struggled with Spring Boot configurations.

T: I had to guide them.

A: I explained basic concepts, reviewed their code daily, and helped them fix issues.

R: They became confident and started working independently.

7. Tell me about a time you prevented a major issue before it happened.

STAR Answer

S: I saw that our SQL query did not have limit and could return huge data.

T: I needed to prevent potential crash.

A: I optimized the query, added pagination, and tested load.

R: No memory issues occurred in production later.

8. Describe a time you managed stakeholder expectations.

STAR Answer

S: Product team wanted a feature completed in two days.

T: But actual effort was more.

A: I explained the effort, shared breakdown, and offered a realistic timeline.

R: They agreed and appreciated honest communication.

9. Tell me a time you improved code quality in your team.

STAR Answer

S: Our PR reviews were slow and inconsistent.

T: We needed better quality checks.

A: I created coding guidelines, added Sonar rules, and reviewed PRs more strictly.

R: Quality improved and review time reduced.

10. Describe a time you handled an unexpected failure.

STAR Answer

S: Our service suddenly started timing out at night.

T: I had to find the cause.

A: I checked server logs, found GC spikes, increased heap size, and fixed memory leak.

R: Service ran smoothly after the fix.

JAVA Interview Buddy